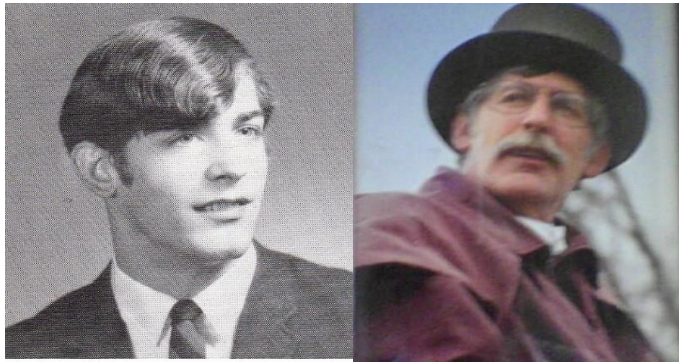


WHS
1969



Caswell Robert

Last Updated	8/8/2018
Status	Located
Full Name	Robert Glenn Caswell
Nickname	Bob
Location	Fairfax, VA
Personal Website	
Business Website	rcaswell-writing.com
Birthday	Dec. 20
Spouse/Partner	Jane Hill Caswell
Children	1 Daughter Jade, 1 Son Robert
Employer	Self-employed
Facebook	https://www.facebook.com/robert.caswell.79
U.S. Armed Forces	US Air Force Vet

Bio My Worldview

I occasionally drive for ride-share companies. I live in northern Virginia, near Washington, DC.

Washington is very often called “the capital of the free world”, and as such, attracts people from all over the world. I have given rides to people who were born in over one hundred different countries. That means over one hundred cultures, ideals, and worldviews.

Living in Virginia so close to DC, I had a very clear idea of how the world worked, or so I thought. You be the judge.

Displaying Christmas

I decorate my car to celebrate the holidays. Never a lot, just stuff I can get from the dollar store so the whole effort is less than \$20.00. For Christmas, I drape colored tinsel across the backs of the front seat and hang various flavors of candy canes on it. The candy canes are for my passengers to enjoy doing their day. Not everyone takes one. A few need some convincing, like the lobbyists. But once I tell them to take one with them and give it to the first receptionist they meet to maybe help grease the wheels a little, they are quick to join the Christmas spirit.

I also hang some stocking from the back of the headrests and put sugar-free candy in them. (I don't want to leave anyone out of my celebration!)

Special Passengers

I never really thought about what message I was sending to the world. After all, my version of Christmas is not a staple in many of the world's cultures. One day I picked up an Islamic woman and her seven-year-old son. As soon as she got in my car, she started gushing about how happy she was that I was not hiding my feelings from her. I guess that when people see her wearing a head scarf, they start walking on egg-shells so as not to offend her.

She was telling me that it meant so much to her that I treated her like every other human being I meet. It made her very happy to be included in my celebration. (Her son was very happy also. He got free candy cane. Different priorities.)

I felt pretty good also. It taught me that it is not politically incorrect to believe in what I believe, as-long-as I don't discriminate about what others might believe.

People Are All the Same

I enjoy having conversations with my passengers. It is usually pretty light. Sometimes they ask me if I can tell where they are from. This happened one day and I said it was probably Ethiopia or Eritrea. They just had those features.

It turned out to be Ethiopia. Then I was asked if I had ever visited their country. I said, "No. I don't want to be killed!"

They asked why I said that, and I responded that I am American. They said, "So?"

I said, "Doesn't everyone want to kill Americans? I would not be very safe."

They said, "Maybe one or two people in the country, but most would embrace us. If I wanted to be killed, maybe I should go to New York City! What makes me think that?" I responded that the things that are important to me are family, food, and comfort. It turns out that it is the same for them. Highest on the list is their family, then that they have food, and third, if they are comfortable, or the weather.

I said, "That's what I believe! You are from Africa, you are supposed to think something else!"

They said, "Sorry."

It turns out that everyone, all over the world list the same priorities. It is not until the influence of politics or religion that additional things are added. I guess we are all human.

My Reaction

I was telling this story one night over dinner, and my Daughter-in-Law said it was good for me.

Now she is an Irish Catholic from Massachusetts and somewhat liberal. I am somewhat conservative, so we have many disagreements about how the world should work. But she is still the best thing that ever happened to my son. Her strong will and temper keeps him on the straight and narrow.

I said, "What do you mean, 'It's good for me.'"

She said, "It makes you a better person, so it's good for you to realize that."

I said, "The one does not mean the other. It is change! I don't do change! It is not good for me!"

(She may be right, but I enjoy the relationship, so don't tell her I said so.)

This job does change my worldview, a little.

